

RESEARCH PROJECT IN APPLIED MATHEMATICS 2026

BScHons (Applied Mathematics), Stellenbosch University

Important dates:

2 Feb 2026	The year's list of project topics is made available.
10 Feb 2026	Students indicate their preferences.
13 Feb 2026	Projects are assigned.

15–26 Jun 2026	Project block
20–24 Jul 2026	Oral presentations and submission of interim reports

30 Oct 2026	Submission of reports for examination
6 Nov 2026	Project summary
16–20 Nov 2026	Final presentations

Progress report due dates:

2 Mar 2026	Topic description and project plan
20 Jul 2026	Interim report

NOTE: All late submissions will be penalized with 5% per day.

Topic description:

- The topic description part of your first progress report is a 1- or 2-page introduction of your topic.
- It must be typed in LaTeX. Clarity, neatness and conciseness are important.
- The report should contain a clear project definition and what you plan on doing.
- Feel free to use figures or tables, as needed.
- Appropriate references should be stated.
- Save your document as `Topic_Initial_Surname.pdf` (Example: `Topic_A_Roux.pdf`)
- Submit a PDF on STEMLearn by 14:00 on 2 March 2026.

Project plan:

- A project plan is a 1-2 page document containing:
 - a clear plan on how you want to execute your project;
 - dates on which certain parts of your project should be completed.
- Clarity, neatness and conciseness are important.
- Feel free to use figures or tables, as needed.
- Save your document as `ProjectPlan_Initial_Surname.pdf`
- Submit a PDF on STEMLearn by 14:00 on 2 March 2026.

Interim project report (5%):

- The interim report is a document of between 10 and 15 pages containing:
 - a clear project definition (or problem statement);
 - some motivation and background (including appropriate references);
 - what you have done (which might include preliminary results);
 - what you plan on doing in the remainder of the project;
 - a provisional list of references;
 - your original project plan together with a new and improved version.
- Your advisor can (and should) help you with the preparation of this report, by reading drafts and making suggestions, so start early.
- Save your document as `InterimReport_Initial_Surname.pdf`
- Submit a PDF on STEMLearn by 14:00 on 20 July 2026. Please remember to also give your advisor a copy of your report.

Interim presentation:

- This is an oral presentation of your interim report.
- The audience will consist of Applied Mathematics lecturers and postgraduate students.
- It will take place during the week of 20 –24 July 2026 in room A308.
- Each of you will get a 15min time slot: 10min for talking and 5min for questions.
- Again, your advisor can help you with your preparation. Consider a “dry run” with your advisor a day or two before the time.
- View this as an opportunity to learn and improve upon your public speaking skills.

Project report (90%):

- This is the final document that presents your project, to be sent to your examiners (people appointed by us for the task of assessing your work). It is arguably the most important deliverable of your project.
- Format: minimum 25 to maximum 35 pages, single column, typeset in LaTeX.
- Language: English or Afrikaans (your choice).
- Technical, stylistic and linguistic quality is of the utmost importance.
- Be sure to allow enough time for your advisor to read through draft versions, and for you to address any suggested corrections, before the submission deadline.
- Save your document as `Project_Initial_Surname.pdf`
- Submit a PDF on STEMLearn by 14:00 on 30 October 2026. Please remember to also give your advisor a copy of your report.

Project summary (5%):

- This is an executive summary of your project.
- Format: Exactly 1 page and precisely two images. (See template on STEMLearn.)
- Language: English/Afrikaans/Xhosa (your choice).
- Concisely convey the key ideas and results of your project in a non-technical manner.
- Save your document as `Summary_Initial_Surname.pdf`
- Submit a PDF on STEMLearn by 14:00 on 6 November 2026.

Final presentation:

- You will give a 10min presentation on your completed project.
- See this as an opportunity to advertise not only your work but also yourself. Be professional and well-prepared.
- Your 10min talk will be followed by a few minutes of questions from the audience/examiner.